Ivan Yuri P. De Leon

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Education

Ateneo de Manila University — *Master in Data Science*, Metro Manila, PH May 2026

- Graduate Assistant (Mathematics; Environmental Science): taught calculus reviews; organized events, handling logistics, communications and creative assets.
- Capstone with the Bank of the Philippine Islands: introduced and proved properties of a new metric for how distinctive a merchant is to each customer, applied with community detection and graph neural networks.

Ateneo de Manila University — *BS Applied Mathematics* (*Data Science*), *Minor in Economics*, Metro Manila, PH May 2025

- Summa Cum Laude; University Academic Scholar (full tuition); DOST Scholar (national STEM scholarship).

Research

Conference Papers

- **I.Y. De Leon**, L.R. Fermin, Z.A. Africa, R.I. Flores. "TDR: Tagalog Diacritic Restoration Dataset." *O-COCOSDA 2026* (oral). arXiv:2610.17597.
- **I.Y. De Leon**, H. Ouchi, S. Sakti. "Tanawpamana: Benchmarking Vision-Language Models on Philippine Cultural Heritage Sites." *O-COCOSDA 2026* (poster). arXiv:2610.17596.
- S. Angeles, E. Panugayan, **I.Y. De Leon**, C. Cheng, T. Tiam-Lee. "FilSwitch: A Filipino–English Code-Switched Speech Dataset." *O-COCOSDA 2026* (poster).

Preprints

- V. Zouhar et al. (incl. **I.Y. De Leon**). "Last Translation Benchmark." arXiv:2609.04173.
- J.R. Montalan, D.D. Africa, J.P. Layacan, R.I. Flores, **I.Y. De Leon**, L.C. Gamboa. "PACUTE: Phonology-, Affix-, and Character-level Understanding of Tokens for Filipino." arXiv:2606.15144.

Reports

- **I.Y. De Leon**, A. Malubay. "We Are Convinced That Persuasion is Linear and Bilingual in LLMs." *Apart Research Global South AI Safety Hackathon*, 2026. Report.

Research Positions

Gigascale Laboratories — *Visiting Researcher*, Remote Jun–Aug 2026

- Continued my TARA alignment-drift work by building a sandbox that simulates multi-agent social media.
- Studied how a single agent's alignment degrades under sustained exposure to adversarial or roleplaying peer agents.

Technical Alignment Research Accelerator (TARA) — *AI Alignment Fellow*, Metro Manila, PH (hybrid) Mar–Jun 2026

- Alignment fellowship covering transformers, mechanistic interpretability, RL, LLM evaluation and agents.
- Developed a persuasion-based jailbreaking method in Filipino that outperformed English prompts in most risk categories.
- Studied alignment drift in multi-agent systems using mechanistic interpretability; recognized among the cohort's top projects.

Nara Institute of Science and Technology — *Research Intern, Human-AI Interaction Lab*, Nara, Japan Jan 2026

- Built a benchmark evaluating vision-language models on recognition and knowledge of Philippine cultural heritage sites, using UK AISI's Inspect framework; developed into the Tanawpamana paper.

Professional Experience

Globe Telecom — *AI Forward Deployed Engineer*, Metro Manila, PH Sep 2026–Present

- Embedded with business units to take AI solutions for telco use cases from discovery to deployment.

Safe AI Philippines — *Head, AI Governance Career Accelerator*, Metro Manila, PH Jul 2026–Present

- Co-lead Batch 2 of a 10-week AI governance career accelerator for 30+ mid- to senior-career professionals: curriculum, project-phase design and discussion facilitation.
- Founding member relaunching AI Safety Diliman as Safe AI PH, envisioned to be the country's national AI safety hub.

Ayala Corporation — *Data Analytics and AI Intern*, Metro Manila, PH Apr–Sep 2025

- Identified drivers of car sales from dealership data with AC Mobility; findings were adopted into their forecasting model.
- Modeled early-adopter behavior in a mobility app with Markov chains to inform feature prioritization.
- Built an automated HR analytics dashboard tracking core workforce KPIs, including headcount, attrition and leave.

Bank of the Philippine Islands — *Data Science Intern*, Metro Manila, PH Jun–Aug 2024

- Built projects on explainable AI for credit risk, product recommendation, customer segmentation and web scraping.

Additional Information

- **Training:** TARA; BlueDot Impact (Technical AI Safety); Safe AI Philippines AI Governance Career Accelerator (Batch 1).
- **Literary awards:** National Youth Achievement in Literary Arts (Philippine National Committee on Literary Arts, 2025); Ateneo College Award in the Arts (2025); Mulry Award for Literary Excellence (ADMU, 2025).